

MS.3 Inspection Sequence

The order inspections happen in, what each one is really checking — and what to do instead when your county does not send anybody.

Before you use this document

This is a process reference, not legal advice. Mississippi is the hardest state in the country to write a permit guide for, because the answer genuinely changes at the county line: some counties enforce a building code and inspect your house, and others enforce none at all. Confirm every item with the office that will actually issue your permit before you rely on it.

TWO REALITIES, AND YOU NEED TO KNOW WHICH IS YOURS

Work MS.4 before this document. If a building code is enforced on your parcel, the first half of this sheet is your schedule and you should record every visit on it. If no code is enforced, the first half is still your **quality plan** — the same milestones, bought privately instead of provided publicly — and the second half explains why that is worth paying for.

The inspections are the code's, not the state's

Mississippi has no statewide inspection schedule, because it has no statewide inspection program. The sequence below is the one the **International Residential Code** produces, and a Mississippi jurisdiction gets it only by adopting the IRC. Which edition it adopted is a local question — the statute permits "*one (1) of the last three (3) adopted editions*," so the details shift a little between neighboring counties.

Treat the list as the shape of the process rather than a checklist your inspector will recognize word for word. **Ask your building official for their own inspection list at the time you pull the permit** and write any differences into the notes column.

THE SEQUENCE — RECORD EVERY VISIT HERE

Call for each inspection when the work is complete and still **open to view**. The expensive mistake in every state is covering work before it is approved; the remedy is opening it back up at your cost.

Site and foundation

	Item	Date	Notes / corrections
☐	Temporary power — the pole or pedestal your utility requires before it will energize the site Date: _____ Result: _____		

Site and foundation

	Item	Date	Notes / corrections
☐	Footing — trenches excavated to bearing, reinforcement in place, forms set. Called before any concrete arrives Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Slab / foundation — vapor retarder, reinforcement, anchor bolt layout, and any under-slab work complete Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Under-slab plumbing — drain, waste and vent below the slab, usually held under test pressure while the inspector looks Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Termite pretreatment — Mississippi lies wholly within the region the IRC marks " very heavy " for termite infestation, so an adopted IRC requires protection. Keep the treatment certificate; lenders and buyers ask for it Date: _____ Company: _____		

Frame and rough-in

	Item	Date	Notes / corrections
☐	Framing and sheathing — after the building is dried in, before anything is concealed. On the coast this is also where the continuous load path is checked: straps, clips, and the fastening schedule Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Electrical rough-in — boxes, cable, service, grounding and bonding, before insulation Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Plumbing rough-in — supply, drain, waste and vent under test Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Mechanical rough-in — duct, refrigerant lines, combustion air, flue and fuel gas piping under test Date: _____ Result: _____		

Frame and rough-in

	Item	Date	Notes / corrections
☐	Insulation and air sealing — after all rough-ins pass, before drywall. The energy provisions come from whichever IRC edition your jurisdiction adopted, so confirm what yours expects Date: _____ Result: _____		

Finals

	Item	Date	Notes / corrections
☐	Final electrical — devices, panel schedule, arc-fault and ground-fault protection, smoke and carbon monoxide alarms Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Final plumbing — fixtures set, traps and vents complete, water heater relief piping Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Final mechanical — equipment running, condensate handled, combustion appliances vented and tested Date: _____ Result: _____		
☐	Septic approval — the health department's sign-off on the onsite system. On most rural parcels this gates occupancy in practice, and it is required whether or not a building code applies Date: _____ Document #: _____		
☐	Final building / certificate of occupancy — grading and drainage, steps, guards, handrails, address numbers. <i>Where no building code is enforced there is no certificate of occupancy at all</i> Date: _____ CO #: _____		

IF NOBODY IS COMING — BUYING YOUR OWN INSPECTIONS

In a Mississippi county that adopted no code, or that opted out in 2014, there is no plan review, no permit and no inspector. That is lawful, and the licensing statute assumes it — one of the exemptions in § 73-59-15 is written specifically for "*any county or municipality which does not require a building permit or any local certification for such construction.*" But three parties will still want evidence that your house was built properly, and none of them accepts "the county

did not require it" as an answer.

Who asks, even when the county does not

Party	What they need from you
Your lender	Construction lending is released in draws against inspected progress. A lender in a no-code county will usually send its own inspector, or require you to supply third-party reports, before releasing each draw. Ask what they want before you close, because it sets your inspection schedule.
Your insurer	Builder's risk during construction, and the homeowner policy afterward, are both priced on how the house was built. On the coast, wind-mitigation features are what make wind coverage affordable — and they have to be documented by someone at the time they are installed, because they are invisible once the house is finished.
Your buyer, one day	An owner-built house with no permit history and no inspection reports is a harder sale and a slower one. A folder of dated third-party reports and photographs turns "unpermitted" into "documented," which is a different conversation entirely.

Buy the same milestones the code would have given you. A licensed home inspector or a structural engineer will visit for a few hundred dollars a trip. Four visits — footing, framing, pre-drywall with the rough-ins exposed, and final — cover the moments where a defect becomes permanently hidden. Photograph everything yourself in addition, date-stamped, and keep it with this binder.

Your private inspection plan (no-code parcels)

	Item	Date	Notes / evidence
☐	Third-party inspector or engineer engaged, and the four visits booked into the schedule rather than called at the last minute Firm: _____ Booked: _____		
☐	Lender's own inspection and draw requirements confirmed in writing before closing Confirmed: _____		
☐	Builder's risk insurer asked what documentation it wants during construction Confirmed: _____		
☐	Photographs at each milestone — footings before pour, framing and connectors, all rough-ins before insulation, insulation before drywall		
☐	Termite treatment performed and certificate filed, even with no inspector to show it to Date: _____ Company: _____		

Your private inspection plan (no-code parcels)

	Item	Date	Notes / evidence
☐	Septic system approval obtained from the health department — this one is not optional and does not depend on your building-code status Date: _____ Document #: _____		
☐	Every trade contractor's State Board of Contractors license verified before they started — the zero-dollar rule in § 73-59-3(1)(d) applies whether or not anyone inspects the work		

THREE MISSISSIPPI CONDITIONS WORTH AN EXTRA LOOK

- **Termites.** The whole state sits in the IRC's "very heavy" infestation region, and the coast additionally contends with the Formosan subterranean termite. Soil treatment, a bait system or an approved barrier is the code answer where a code applies, and the sensible answer everywhere else.
- **Expansive clay.** Parts of central Mississippi, notably the Jackson metropolitan area, sit on soils that shrink and swell enough to move a slab. A geotechnical report before you design the foundation costs far less than the repair does. This is a soils question, not a code question, and no inspector will raise it for you.
- **Wind and flood on the coast.** In Jackson, Harrison, Hancock, Stone and Pearl River counties the 2006 law imposed wind and flood mitigation requirements — subject to the opt-out described in MS.4. Whatever your county's status, the insurance market on the coast prices these features whether or not an inspector checks them, and the connectors have to be documented while they are still visible.

Sources — every Mississippi claim in this document (verified August 2026)

What this document states	Authority
There is no statewide Mississippi inspection schedule; the sequence comes from whichever edition of the International Residential Code the local jurisdiction adopted, and the statute allows any of the last three adopted editions	SB 2378 (2014) § 1(1); § 17-2-3(5)
Building in a jurisdiction that requires no building permit or local certification is contemplated by the licensing statute itself	§ 73-59-15(1)(g)
Electrical, plumbing, mechanical and HVAC contractors must hold a state license no matter the dollar amount, inspected or not	§ 73-59-3(1)(d)
Wind and flood mitigation requirements for the five named coastal counties, and the opt-out that accompanied them	§ 17-2-1; HB 1406 (2006) § 1

Sources — every Mississippi claim in this document (verified August 2026)

What this document states	Authority
Residential fire sprinklers are excluded from the IRC as adopted statewide, though a county or municipality may still require them	SB 2378 (2014) § 1(1)(b); § 17-2-3(7)

*Every Mississippi Code section cited above is free to read. The Legislature's official copy is at **legislature.ms.gov** → Mississippi Code (Title 73, Chapter 59 is residential builders; Title 17, Chapter 2 is building codes; Title 41, Chapter 67 is onsite wastewater). The State Board of Contractors publishes the whole residential law and its rules as one booklet at **msboc.us** → Laws, and the Department of Health publishes the wastewater law at **msdh.ms.gov**. Enacted bills — which is how the dates and opt-out windows in this kit were checked — are at **billstatus.ls.state.ms.us**. All statute text quoted in this kit was read at those sources and verified August 2026.*